

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250273499

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

August 28, 2025

Inventor(s)

PARKHE; Vijay D.

ELECTROSTATIC CHUCK FOR NON-PLANAR SUBSTRATES

Abstract

Embodiments of the disclosure include an electrostatic chuck (ESC). The ESC includes a substrate support including a first segment and a second segment that is laterally adjacent to the first segment. The first segment includes a first pair of electrodes. The second segment includes a second pair of electrodes. The first segment is to be displaced vertically relative to the second segment to accommodate a non-planar surface of a substrate.

Inventors: PARKHE; Vijay D. (San Jose, CA)

Applicant: Applied Materials, Inc. (Santa Clara, CA)

Family ID: 1000008462432

Appl. No.: 19/051244

Filed: February 12, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63559056 20240228

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H01L21/683 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H01L21/6833 (20130101);

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This Application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application 63/559,056 filed on Feb. 28, 2024, and entitled “Electrostatic Chuck For Non-Planar Substrates,” the contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND

Field

[0002] Embodiments described herein generally relate to a system and methods used in semiconductor device manufacturing. More specifically, embodiments of the present disclosure relate to an electrostatic chuck (ESC) for use with substrates having non-planar surfaces.

Description of the Related Art

[0003] An electrostatic chuck (ESC) is device used in semiconductor manufacturing to support and retain a substrate while the substrate is being processed. In order to support and retain the substrate, a DC bias is applied to pairs of electrodes disposed within the ESC. The applied DC bias generates an electrostatic force that attracts the substrate to a surface of the ESC. If the substrate is in close enough proximity to the surface of the ESC, then maintaining the applied DC bias (and the electrostatic force) may support and retain the substrate on the surface. By increasing the DC bias, the substrate can be urged towards the surface of the ESC even when portions of the substrate and the surface are initially separated by a small distance (e.g., one millimeter).

[0004] However, if portions of the substrate and the surface of the ESC are initially separated by a sufficiently large distance, then increasing the DC bias is generally unable to generate enough electrostatic force to attract the substrate to the surface of the ESC. When a particular substrate is warped or bowed in higher order mode shapes, it is possible for some portions of the particular substrate to be excessively separated from the surface of the ESC while other portions of the particular substrate are contacting the surface of the ESC. In these scenarios, using conventional chucking processes, the substrate must first be flattened (e.g., using a vacuum) before the particular substrate can be attracted to the surface of the ESC. However, flattening the substrate is an inefficient process and could result in damage to the substrate.

[0005] Accordingly, there is a need in the art for an ESC that solves the problems described above.

SUMMARY

[0006] To the accomplishment of the foregoing and related ends, the one or more aspects comprise the features hereinafter fully described and particularly pointed out in the claims. The following description and the appended drawings set forth in detail certain illustrative features of the one or more aspects. These features are indicative, however, of but a few of the various ways in which the principles of various aspects may be employed.

[0007] Embodiments of the present disclosure provide an electrostatic chuck (ESC) which includes a substrate support. A first segment of the substrate support includes a first pair of electrodes and the first segment is coupled to a first portion of a membrane. A second segment of the substrate support includes a second pair of electrodes and the second segment is coupled to a second portion of the membrane. The second pair of electrodes is configured to be positioned in a first direction relative to the first pair of electrodes and the first pair of electrodes is configured to be positioned in the first direction relative to the second pair of electrodes. A third segment of the substrate support includes a third pair of electrodes and the third segment is coupled to a third portion of the membrane. The third pair of electrodes is configured to be positioned in the first direction relative to the first pair of electrodes and the second pair of electrodes.

[0008] Embodiments of the present disclosure provide a method for chucking a substrate to a substrate support. The method generally includes detecting a first maximum distance between a surface of a first segment of the substrate support and a first portion of the substrate and detecting a second maximum distance between a surface of a second segment of the substrate support and a second portion of the substrate. A first pair of electrodes included in the first segment is actuated a first distance towards the first portion of the substrate. The first distance is less than the first

maximum distance. A second pair of electrodes included in the second segment is actuated a second distance towards the second portion of the substrate. The second distance is less than the second maximum distance. A DC bias is applied to the first pair of electrodes and the second pair of electrodes.

[0009] Some embodiments disclosed herein are directed to an ESC that includes a substrate support including a first segment and a second segment that is laterally adjacent to the first segment. The first segment includes a first pair of electrodes. The second segment includes a second pair of electrodes. The first segment is configured to be displaced vertically relative to the second segment to accommodate a non-planar surface of a substrate.

[0010] Some embodiments disclosed herein are directed to a method for chucking a substrate to a substrate support. The method includes determining a first distance between a surface of a first segment of the substrate support and a first portion of the substrate and determining a second distance between a surface of a second segment of the substrate support and a second portion of the substrate. In addition, the method includes actuating the first segment toward the first portion of the substrate to reduce the first distance and actuating the second segment toward the second portion of the substrate to reduce the second distance. Further, the method includes) applying a DC bias to a first pair of electrodes included in the first segment and to a second pair of electrodes included in the second segment to chuck the first and second portions of the substrate to the first and second segments, respectively.

[0011] Some embodiments disclosed herein are directed to an ESC that includes a substrate support including a first segment and a second segment that is laterally adjacent to the first segment. In addition, the ESC includes a first actuator coupled to the first segment that is configured to vertically displace the first segment to reduce a distance between the first segment and a surface of a substrate and a second actuator coupled to the second segment that is configured to vertically displace the second segment to reduce a distance between the second segment and the surface of the substrate. Further, the ESC includes a first pair of electrodes coupled to the first segment that, when energized, are configured to generate a first electrostatic force to urge the substrate toward the first segment and a second pair of electrodes coupled to the second segment that, when energized, are configured to generate a second electrostatic force to urge the substrate toward the second segment.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0012] So that the manner in which the above recited features of embodiments of the present disclosure can be understood in detail, a more particular description of the disclosure, briefly summarized above, may be had by reference to embodiments, some of which are illustrated in the appended drawings. It is to be noted, however, that the appended drawings illustrate only typical embodiments of this disclosure and are therefore not to be considered limiting of its scope, for the disclosure may admit to other equally effective embodiments.

[0013] FIG. 1A is a schematic representation of an example substrate processing system, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0014] FIG. 1B illustrates an example of actuating a segment of a substrate support in a first direction, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 1C illustrates an example of actuating a segment of a substrate support in a second direction, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 1D illustrates an example of actuating a segment of a substrate support in a third direction, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 2 illustrates a representation of example arrangements of segments of a substrate

support, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0018] FIGS. 3A and 3B illustrate examples of layers of a diaphragm disposed over segments of a substrate support, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIGS. 4A, 4B, and 4C illustrate representations of chucking a concave substrate, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIGS. 5A, 5B, and 5C illustrate representations of chucking a convex substrate, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIGS. 6A, 6B, and 6C illustrate examples of a membrane disposed below segments of a substrate support, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0022] FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate examples of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) including two segments, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0023] FIGS. 8A and 8B illustrate examples of an ESC including five segments, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0024] FIGS. 9A and 9B illustrate examples of an ESC including eight segments, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. 10 is a flow diagram illustrating a method for substrate processing by chucking a substrate to a substrate support, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure.

[0026] To facilitate understanding, the same reference numerals have been used, where possible, to designate shared elements that are common to the figures. It is contemplated that elements disclosed in one embodiment may be beneficially utilized on other embodiments without specific recitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0027] Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to apparatus and methods for substrate processing. More specifically, embodiments described herein provide for an electrostatic chuck (ESC) for electrostatically chucking deformed or otherwise non-planar substrates to a substrate support surface of the ESC. In some embodiments, a first distance is detected between a surface of a first segment of the substrate support and first portion of a substrate, and a second distance is detected between a surface of a second segment of the substrate support and a second portion of the substrate.

[0028] In one or more embodiments, the substrate is deformed (e.g., bowed) such that portions of the substrate are different distances from the substrate support. In some examples, the first and second distances are too far from the substrate support to attract and immobilize the substrate on the substrate support by generating an electrostatic force. In various embodiments, a first actuator actuates a first pair of electrodes included in the first segment towards the first portion of the substrate to reduce the first distance between the surface of the first segment and the first portion of the substrate. In one or more examples, a second actuator actuates a second pair of electrodes included in the second segment towards the second portion of the substrate to reduce the second distance between the surface of the second segment and the second portion of the substrate.

[0029] In some embodiments, a DC bias is applied to the first pair of electrodes and the second pair of electrodes. In various examples, the DC bias generates electrostatic forces which attract the first portion of the substrate to the surface of the first segment and also attract the second portion of the substrate to the surface of the second segment. By actuating and adjusting the distance between the first and second pairs of electrodes and the substrate, the substrate can be chucked to the surface of the ESC without first flattening the substrate as often performed during conventional chucking processes. This increases efficiency of processing the substrate and may avoid the risk of damaging the substrate (e.g., during a flattening process).

[0030] FIG. 1A is a schematic representation of an example substrate processing system 100. The substrate processing system 100 is representative of a variety of different systems including, without limitation, chemical vapor deposition (CVD) systems, plasma vapor deposition (PVD) systems, etching systems (including plasma-assisted systems and non-plasma-assisted systems),

electron beam systems, etc. The substrate processing system **100** is illustrated to include a processing chamber **106** which contains a processing volume **108**.

[0031] As shown in FIG. **1A**, a substrate support **110** of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) is disposed within the processing volume **108**. The substrate support **110** is illustrated to include segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**. The segment **112-1** is adjacent (such as laterally adjacent) to the segment **112-2**, and the segment **112-2** is adjacent (such as laterally adjacent) to the segment **112-3**. For instance, the segment **112-1** has a surface **114-1** (such as a top surface). A pair of electrodes **116-1** is disposed within the segment **112-1** below the surface **114-1**. The segment **112-1** is coupled to an actuator **118-1** which is configured to actuate the segment **112-1** within the processing volume **108**. The actuator **118-1** is representative of a variety of different types of actuators capable of adjusting the position of the segment **112-1**. In various embodiments, the actuator **118-1** may be electrical (e.g., includes a solenoid actuator, a DC motor, a stepper motor, a linear motor, etc.), hydraulic, electrohydraulic, pneumatic, piezoelectric, magnetostrictive, and/or any other type of actuator. In some examples, the actuator **118-1** includes a membrane (e.g., thin metal or polymer disk) that encloses a pressurizable region formed within the substrate support **110** that is configured to cause movement (e.g., deformation) of a surface of the membrane due to the adjustment of a fluid pressure or application of a vacuum pressure applied to the pressurizable region. In some examples, the actuator **118-1** includes a piezoelectric actuator or solenoid type actuator that is configured to adjust the position of the segment **112-1**, **112-2**, or **112-3** that it is coupled to during processing.

[0032] Like the segment **112-1**, the segment **112-2** has a surface **114-2** (such as a top surface) and a pair of electrodes **116-2** disposed below the surface **114-2**. The segment **112-3** also has a surface **114-3** (such as a top surface) and a pair of electrodes **116-3** disposed below the surface **114-3**. The segment **112-2** is coupled to an actuator **118-2** which is configured to actuate the segment **112-2** within the processing volume **108**. In some examples, the actuator **118-2** is a same type of actuator as the actuator **118-1**. In other examples, the actuator **118-2** can be a different type of actuator than the actuator **118-1**. Similarly, the segment **112-3** is also coupled to an actuator **118-3** that is configured to actuate the segment **112-3** within the processing volume **108**.

[0033] In some embodiments, a printed circuit board (PCB) **120** is disposed below the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**. In other embodiments, the PCB **120** may be disposed in different orientations relative to the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**. In the illustrated example, the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** are electrically connected to a circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120**, and the electrical components (e.g., electrical actuators (e.g., solenoid, piezoelectric device), switches, fluid valves, etc.) of the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** used to cause an actuating motion are electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**. A DC voltage source **124** is also illustrated to be electrically connected to the circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120**. In various embodiments, the DC voltage source **124** is capable of outputting example voltages of ± 5000 V, $\pm 10,000$ V, $\pm 20,000$ V, etc. that can be applied to the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** to generate a bias that is able to generate a chucking force on a substrate disposed over the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, and **114-3**.

[0034] The substrate processing system **100** is illustrated to include a controller **126** which is communicatively coupled (e.g., electrically connected) to the circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120**. In some embodiments, the controller **126** includes a computing device having one or more processors, memory, and storage. The one or more processors can include central processing units, graphics processing units, accelerators, etc. The memory includes main memory for storing instructions for the one or more processors to execute or data for the one or more processors to operate on. For example, the memory includes random access memory (RAM). The storage includes mass storage for data or instructions. As an example and not by way of limitation, the storage may include a removable disk drive, flash memory, an optical disc, a magneto-optical disc, magnetic tape, or a Universal Serial Bus drive or two or more of these. The storage may include removable or fixed media and may be internal or external to the computing device. The storage may include any suitable form of non-volatile, solid-state memory, or read-only memory. The controller **126**

includes a non-transitory computer readable medium or media. The non-transitory computer readable medium or media may include one or more semiconductor-based or other integrated circuits (ICs) (such, as for example, field-programmable gate arrays or application-specific ICs), hard disk drives, hybrid hard drives, optical discs, optical disc drives, magneto-optical discs, magneto-optical drives, solid-state drives, RAM drives, any other suitable non-transitory computer readable storage medium/media, or any suitable combination. The non-transitory computer readable medium or media may be volatile, non-volatile, or a combination of volatile and non-volatile.

[0035] The PCB **120** (e.g., the circuit layer **122**) includes multiple transistors (e.g., MOSFETs) configured as switches. In some embodiments, the controller **126** is capable of controlling the transistors included in the PCB **120** to open or close electrical connections between the DC voltage source **124** and the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3**. Similarly, in some embodiments, the controller **126** is capable of controlling the transistors included in the PCB **120** to open or close electrical connections between a power supply **128** and the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to selectively power the electrical components used to cause the movement and positioning of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** by the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3**. In various embodiments, the power supply **128** can be an AC power supply, a DC power supply, or representative of an AC power supply and a DC power supply.

[0036] In some examples, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close electrical connections between the DC voltage source **124** and the pair of electrodes **116-1**, the pair of electrodes **116-2**, and/or the pair of electrodes **116-3**. In these examples, closing the electrical connections applies a DC bias to the pair of electrodes **116-1**, the pair of electrodes **116-2**, and/or the pair of electrodes **116-3**. For example, if the DC bias is applied to the pair of electrodes **116-1**, then the DC bias generates an electrostatic force that acts on the portion of the substrate disposed over the surface **114-1**. While not intending to be bound by theory, generated electrostatic forces are typically capable of attracting a portion of a substrate to the surface **114-1** if the portion of the substrate is a relatively small distance (e.g., one millimeter) from the pair of electrodes **116-1**. In one non-limiting example, when a bias voltage of about 1 kV for a Johnsen-Rahbek ESC and about 3 kV for a Coulombic ESC is applied between a pair of electrodes the applied bias is able to cause movement in a portion of a deformed silicon substrate that is spaced about one millimeter from the surface **114-1** of the electrostatic chuck.

[0037] If the portion of the substrate is spaced too far from the pair of electrodes **116-1**, then the electrostatic force generated by the DC bias is insufficient to attract the portion of the substrate to the surface **114-1**. In order to decrease the distance between the pair of electrodes **116-1** and the portion of the substrate, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions that cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close an electrical connection between the power supply **128** and the actuator **118-1**. Supplying power from the power supply **128** to the actuator **118-1** causes the actuator **118-1** to actuate the segment **112-1** relative to the position of the portion of the substrate. In some examples, actuating the segment **112-1** relative to the portion of the substrate decreases the distance between the pair of electrodes **116-1** and the portion of the deformed substrate until the electrostatic force is sufficient to attract the portion of the substrate to the surface **114-1** of the segment **112-1**.

[0038] Thus, in some embodiments, each of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** are configured to be displaced (e.g., via actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3**) relative to the other segments. As will be described in more detail herein, in some embodiments, one or more of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** may be configured to be displaced vertically (e.g., the Z direction) and possibly also laterally (e.g., in the X-Y plane) relative to the other segments.

[0039] As shown in FIG. **1A**, the substrate processing system **100** includes a gas delivery system **130**, and the gas delivery system **130** is coupled to the processing volume **108**. The gas delivery

system **130** is configured to deliver at least one processing gas (e.g., argon, nitrogen, oxygen, hydrogen, etc.) to the processing volume **108**. In examples in which the substrate processing system **100** includes a plasma-assisted system, the processing gas can include at least one of an inert gas (e.g., helium, argon, nitrogen (N.sub.2)) or dry etching gas (e.g., HBr, HF, HCl, CF.sub.4, NF.sub.3 or XeF.sub.2). In some embodiments, the gas delivery system **130** can include components for activating or energizing one or more processing gasses before delivering the processing gasses to the processing volume **108**. The substrate processing system **100** is also illustrated to include a vacuum source **132** in communication with the processing volume **108**.

[0040] In some embodiments of the substrate support **110**, the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, and **112-3** each further include one or more vacuum chucking ports **125** that include an opening **127** that is formed through the surface **114-1**, **114-2**, and **114-3**. The openings **127** of the vacuum chucking ports **125** are coupled to a line **129** that is coupled to the vacuum source **132** through a controlling valve (not shown) to selectively generate a vacuum pressure at the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, and **114-3** of each of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, and **112-3** by use of commands from the controller **126**. In some embodiments, a vacuum pressure from the vacuum source **132** may be utilized to help flatten a substrate by vacuum chucking the substrate, and/or dechuck the substrate. The one or more vacuum chucking ports **125** can also be used as backside gas delivery ports through which an inert gas is delivered during processing.

[0041] FIG. **1B** illustrates an example **101** of actuating a segment of a substrate support in a first direction. In some embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close an electrical connection between the power supply **128** and the actuator **118-2**. As shown, supplying power from the power supply **128** to the actuator **118-2** causes the actuator **118-2** to actuate (e.g., position) the segment **112-2** in a first direction which is normal to the PCB **120**. The first direction is in a first plane (that extends in the positive Y direction) within the processing volume **108**, and the segment **112-2** is illustrated to be positioned in the first direction. In some embodiments, the segment **112-2** can actuate independently of the segment **112-1** and the segment **112-3** such that the surface **114-2** extends a distance **134** from the surface **114-1** and the surface **114-3**. For example, actuating and translating the segment **112-2** in the first direction may facilitate chucking of a bowed substrate (e.g., backside surface of the substrate is concave) which contacts the surface **114-1** and the surface **114-3** and that extends a distance greater than the relatively small distance from the surface **114-2**.

[0042] FIG. **1C** illustrates an example **102** of actuating a segment of a substrate support in a second direction. In various embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close an electrical connection between the power supply **128** and the actuator **118-1**. As shown, supplying power from the power supply **128** to the actuator **118-1** causes the actuator **118-1** to actuate (e.g., position) the segment **112-1** in a second direction which is at a first slight angle relative to the PCB **120**. The angle shown in FIG. **1C** has been exaggerated for ease of illustration. The second direction is in a second plane (that extends in both the positive Y direction and the negative X direction) within the processing volume **108**. Thus, actuation of segment **112-1** in the second direction may translate the segment **112-1** both vertically and laterally within the processing volume **108** relative to the other segments **112-2**, **112-3**. Specifically, in the example illustrated in FIG. **1C**, the segment **112-1** may be translated both vertically and laterally away from the other segments **112-2**, **112-3** within the processing volume **108**. In some examples, actuating and translating the segment **112-1** in the second direction may facilitate chucking of a bowed substrate which does not contact any of the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3**. The angle of the second direction relative to the first direction can be fixed or adjusted by orienting the displacement direction of the actuator **118-1** based on prior testing or modeling of the bow of a substrate that is commonly provided to the processing chamber **106**. In various embodiments, the segment **112-1** (and the pair

of electrodes **116-1**) may also be positioned in the first direction in which the segment **112-2** is positioned as shown in FIG. **1B**. In some embodiments, a process of positioning the segment **112-1** (and the pair of electrodes **116-1**) a distance in the first direction includes translating the segment **112-1** (and the pair of electrodes **116-1**) a distance in the second direction.

[0043] FIG. **1D** illustrates an example **103** of actuating a segment of a substrate support in a third direction. In certain embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close an electrical connection between the power supply **128** and the actuator **118-1**. As shown, supplying power from the power supply **128** to the actuator **118-1** causes the actuator **118-1** to actuate (e.g., position) the segment **112-1** in a third direction which is at a second slight angle relative to the PCB **120**. The angle shown in FIG. **1D** has been exaggerated for ease of illustration. The third direction is in a third plane (that extends in both the positive Y direction and the positive X direction) within the processing volume **108**. Thus, actuation of segment **112-1** in the third direction may translate the segment **112-1** both vertically and laterally within the processing volume **108** relative to the other segments **112-2**, **112-3**. Specifically, in the example illustrated in FIG. **1D**, the segment **112-1** may be translated both vertically and laterally toward from the other segments **112-2**, **112-3** within the processing volume **108**. For example, actuating and translating the segment **112-1** in the third direction may facilitate chucking of a bowed substrate that contacts the surface **114-2** but does not contact the surface **114-1** or the surface **114-3**. The angle of the third direction relative to the first direction can be fixed or adjusted by orienting the displacement direction of the actuator **118-1** based on prior testing or modeling of the bow of a substrate that is commonly provided to the processing chamber **106**. In some embodiments, the segment **112-1** (and the pair of electrodes **116-1**) may also be positioned in the first direction in which the segment **112-2** is positioned as shown in FIG. **1B**. In one or more embodiments, a process of positioning the segment **112-1** (and the pair of electrodes **116-1**) a distance in the first direction includes translating the segment **112-1** (and the pair of electrodes **116-1**) a distance in the third direction.

[0044] FIG. **2** illustrates a representation **200** of example arrangements of segments (e.g., segments **112**) of a substrate support, in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure. In a first example **110-1**, segments **202** of the substrate support **110** are rectangular in shape and arranged in a set of five segments **202** with a central segment **202** and four segments **202** surrounding the central segment **202**. Similarly, in a second example **110-2**, segments **202** of the substrate support **110** are rectangular in shape and arranged in a set of five segment **202** with a central segment **202** and four segments **202** surrounding the central segment **202**. In a third example **110-3**, segments **202** of the substrate support **110** are circular in shape and arranged in a set of **11** segments **202** with one centered segment **202** encircled by **10** additional segments **202**. It is to be appreciated that the segments **202** of the substrate support **110** may be arranged in a variety of different arrangements and that the examples **110-1**, **110-2**, **110-3** are non-limiting examples. In some embodiments, each of the segments **220** illustrated in the examples are configured to be actuated in a direction that primarily extends in and out of the page (e.g., the Z or vertical direction) of FIG. **2**.

[0045] FIGS. **3A** and **3B** illustrates example top layers that may be disposed over segments of a substrate support. In FIG. **3A**, an example **300** of top layer is shown that comprises a diaphragm **302** constructed from a single layer of the fluoroelastomer, polyimide, or other compliant material disposed over each of the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3**. As shown, in some embodiments, the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** may be disposed in the diaphragm **302**. In certain embodiments, the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** may include multiple alternative electrical connections with the circuit layer **122**, and the diaphragm **302** can have different pairs of electrodes connected to the multiple alternative electrical connections that are oriented differently than the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3**.

[0046] In some embodiments, the fluoroelastomer material of the diaphragm **302** includes a

perfluoroelastomer material. In certain embodiments, the diaphragm **302** covers openings between the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** to avoid discontinuities between a portion of a substrate and the diaphragm **302**. In examples in which the fluoroelastomer material of the diaphragm **302** includes the perfluoroelastomer material, the diaphragm **302** is fluorine resistant and also protects the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** from a variety of corrosive agents which may be utilized within the processing volume **108**. In some embodiments, the diaphragm **302** may be actuated using the vacuum source **132** through a controlling valve (not shown) to selectively generate a vacuum pressure at the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, and **114-3** of each of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, and **112-3** by use of commands from the controller **126**. In one or more examples, the vacuum chucking ports **125** may direct the selectively generated vacuum pressure to cause the diaphragm **302** to actuate away from the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, and **114-3** or towards the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, and **114-3**. In various embodiments, actuating the diaphragm **302** may be configured to manipulate the portion of the substrate, for example, by causing the portion of the substrate to actuate closer to at least one of the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3**.

[0047] In FIG. 3B, an example **301** of multiple top layers **304**, **306**, **308** disposed over the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3** of segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**, respectively, is shown. In some embodiments, the top layers **304**, **306**, **308** may comprise the same material(s) as the diaphragm **302** in FIG. 3A (e.g., a fluoroelastomer, polyimide, or other compliant material). More specifically, in various embodiments, the top layer **304** is disposed over the surface **114-1**; the top layer **306** is disposed over the surface **114-2**; and the top layer **308** is disposed over the surface **114-3**. In some embodiments, the pair of electrodes **116-1** is disposed in the layer **304**; the pair of electrodes **116-2** is disposed in the layer **306**; and the pair of electrodes **116-3** is disposed in the layer **308**. In one or more embodiments, the fluoroelastomer material includes a perfluoroelastomer material which is configured to be resistant to extreme temperatures, fluorine, and corrosive chemistries. In some examples, the layers **304**, **306**, **308** are flexible and capable of mechanically deforming in order to chuck bowed or otherwise non-planar surfaces or portions of substrates.

[0048] FIGS. 4A, 4B, and 4C illustrate representations of chucking a concave substrate (or a substrate having a concave surface), in accordance with certain embodiments of the present disclosure. FIG. 4A illustrates a representation **400** of detecting distances between a surface of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) and a concave substrate **404** and/or detecting the deformed shape of the concave substrate **404**. The representation **400** includes the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**. As shown, the representation **400** also includes indications of a distance **406** (such as a maximum distance or an average distance in some embodiments) between the surface **114-1** and a first portion (e.g., first edge portion) of the concave substrate **404**, a distance **408** (such as a maximum distance or an average distance in some embodiments) between the surface **114-2** and a second portion (e.g., central portion) of the concave substrate **404**, and a distance **410** (such as a maximum distance or an average distance in some embodiments) between the surface **114-3** and a third portion (e.g., second edge portion) of the concave substrate **404**.

[0049] In one or more embodiments, the distance **406** is a distance that is greater than a distance at which applying a DC bias to the pair of electrodes **116-1** generates an electrostatic force capable of attracting the first portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-1**. In various examples, the distance **406** may be greater than 1.0 millimeter such as 1.25 millimeters, 1.5 millimeters, 1.75 millimeters, 2.0 millimeters, etc. In some examples, the distance **406** may be a distance in a range of 1.0 to 10.0 millimeters. In certain embodiments, the distance **406** may be greater than 10.0 millimeters. In various embodiments, the distance **406** may be a percentage of a length, width, or diameter of the concave substrate **404** such as a percentage in a range of 0.33 to 3.33 percent of the length, width, or diameter of the concave substrate **404**.

[0050] In some embodiments, the distances **406**, **408**, **410** are detected by sensors **412**, **414** disposed in the processing volume **108**. The sensors **412**, **414** are representative of a variety of different types and/or combinations of types of sensors which are capable of detecting the

maximum distances **406**, **408**, **410**. In some embodiments, one or more sensors **412**, **414** are disposed in each of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**. The controller **126** is configured to receive the detected distances **406**, **408**, **410** and then adjust the displacement (such as the vertical displacement and/or lateral displacement) of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** by use of the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to compensate for the detected distortion of the concave substrate **404**. In various embodiments, the sensors **412**, **414** can be capacitive sensors that detect the distances **406**, **408**, **410** based on changes in capacitance caused by increasing or decreasing the distance between the concave substrate **404** and the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3**. In certain embodiments, the sensors **412**, **414** may be eddy current sensors that detect the distances **406**, **408**, **410** based on electromagnetic induction. For example, increasing or decreasing the distance between the concave substrate **404** and the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3** affects eddy currents induced in the sensors **412**, **414** enabling detection of the distances **406**, **408**, **410**. In one or more embodiments, the sensors **412**, **414** may leverage electromagnetic induction as inductive sensors that measure changes in inductance caused by increasing or decreasing the distance between the concave substrate **404** and the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3** to detect the distances **406**, **408**, **410**. In various embodiments, the sensors **412**, **414** can be optical sensors (e.g., laser, infrared, etc.) which utilize light reflection or interference in order to detect the distances **406**, **408**, **410**. In some examples, the sensors **412**, **414** are ultrasonic sensors which transmit ultrasonic waves and receive reflected ultrasonic waves. In these examples, the sensors **412**, **414** detect the distances **406**, **408**, **410** based on an amount of time between transmitting the ultrasonic waves and receiving the reflected ultrasonic waves. In certain embodiments, the sensors **412**, **414** may be piezoelectric sensors that generate a voltage in response to a mechanical stress, and then detect the distances **406**, **408**, **410** by measuring the generated voltage. Although particular examples of the sensors **412**, **414** have been described, it is to be appreciated that the sensors **412**, **414** are not limited to these examples and may be any sensors capable of detecting the distances **406**, **408**, **410**.

[0051] In some alternate embodiments, the distances **406**, **408**, **410** can be detected by a substrate bow measurement system (not shown) disposed in a chamber that is within a system that includes the processing volume **108** such that the detected substrate bow can be provided to the controller **126** so that the displacement of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** by the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** can be set to compensate to the detected distortion of the concave substrate **404**. In some embodiments, the distances **406**, **408**, **410** are described by premeasured bow information measured for the concave substrate **404**. In various embodiments, the premeasured bow information can be measured by the substrate bow measurement system and/or the sensors **412**, **414**. In some embodiments, the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404** may also be utilized to dechuck the concave substrate **404**.

[0052] FIG. 4B illustrates a representation **401** of decreasing the distances between the surface of the ESC and the concave substrate **404**. In some embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close electrical connections between the power supply **128** and the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3**. Supplying power to electrical components of the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** from the power supply **128** causes the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to actuate the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3**, respectively, towards the concave substrate **404**. As shown in FIG. 4B, the actuator **118-1** actuates the pair of electrodes **116-1** included in the segment **112-1** a first distance towards the first portion (e.g., the first edge portion) of the concave substrate **404**. In various embodiments, the first distance is included in or based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In one or more embodiments, the first distance is less than the distance **406** (FIG. 4A). In some examples, after actuating the pair of electrodes **116-1** the first distance, the pair of electrodes **116-1** is close enough to the first portion of the concave substrate **404** that applying a DC bias to the pair of electrodes **116-1** generates an electrostatic force capable of attracting the first portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-1**.

[0053] The actuator **118-2** actuates the pair of electrodes **116-2** a second distance towards the second portion (e.g., the central portion) of the concave substrate **404**. In some embodiments, the second distance is included in or based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In one or more examples, the second distance is less than the distance **408** (FIG. 4A). The actuator **118-3** actuates the pair of electrodes **116-3** a third distance towards the third portion (e.g., the second edge portion) of the concave substrate **404**. In certain embodiments, the third distance is included in or based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In some examples, the third distance is less than the distance **410** (FIG. 4A). Similar to actuating the pair of electrodes **116-1** the first distance, after actuating the pair of electrodes **116-2** the second distance, the pair of electrodes **116-2** is close enough to the second portion of the concave substrate **404** that applying the DC bias to the pair of electrodes **116-2** generates an electrostatic force capable of attracting the second portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-2**. After actuating the pair of electrodes **116-3** the third distance, the pair of electrodes **116-3** is close enough to the third portion of the concave substrate **404** that applying the DC bias to the pair of electrodes **116-3** generates an electrostatic force capable of attracting the third portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-3**.

[0054] FIG. 4C illustrates a representation **402** of chucking the concave substrate **404**. In some embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** and close electrical connections between the DC voltage source **124** and the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** which applies the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3**. Electrostatic forces are generated which attract the first portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-1**, the second portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-2**, and the third portion of the concave substrate **404** to the surface **114-3**.

[0055] After chucking the concave substrate **404**, the concave substrate **404** may be flattened using a vacuum pressure from the vacuum source **132** via the vacuum chucking ports **125** and/or by actuating the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to flatten the concave substrate **404**. In some embodiments, the vacuum pressure is included in or based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In certain embodiments, the concave substrate **404** can be processed with or without flattening the concave substrate **404**. In various embodiments, after processing the concave substrate **404**, the concave substrate **404** can be dechucked by ceasing application of the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** and/or by actuating the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to dechuck the concave substrate **404**.

[0056] In some embodiments, the concave substrate **404** is dechucked based on the premeasured bow information in order to avoid undesirable movements (e.g., spring-back) of the concave substrate **404** during the dechucking process. In one or more embodiments, ceasing the application of the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** is performed in a particular order (e.g., the DC bias is ceased for the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-3** before ceasing the application of the DC bias to the pair of electrodes **116-2**) based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In certain embodiments, a manner in which the application of the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes is ceased (e.g., a rate at which the DC bias is reduced) may be based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In some embodiments, distances that the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** are actuated to dechuck the concave substrate **404** can be based on the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404**. In certain embodiments, a manner in which the application of the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes is ceased and/or the movement of the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** towards a substrate's original deformed state during a dechucking process may be based on the premeasured bow information or measured bow information for the concave substrate **404**.

[0057] FIGS. 5A, 5B, and 5C illustrate representations of chucking a convex substrate (or a substrate having a convex surface). FIG. 5A illustrates a representation **500** of detecting distances

between a surface of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) and a convex substrate **504** (or a substrate having a convex surface) and/or detecting the deformed shape of the convex substrate **504**. The representation **500** includes the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** as well as indications of a distance **506** (such as a maximum distance or an average distance in some embodiments) between the surface **114-1** and a first portion (e.g., first edge portion) of the convex substrate **504**, a distance **508** (such as a maximum distance or an average distance in some embodiments) between the surface **114-2** and a second portion (e.g., central portion) of the convex substrate **504**, and a distance **510** (such as a maximum distance or an average distance in some embodiments) between the surface **114-3** and a third portion (e.g., second edge portion) of the convex substrate **504**.

[0058] In various embodiments, the distances **506**, **508**, **510** are detected by sensors **512**, **514**. In some embodiments, the sensors **512**, **514** may be the same sensors as the sensors **412**, **414**. In other embodiments, the sensors **512**, **514** can be different sensors than the sensors **412**, **414**. In certain embodiments, the distances **506**, **508**, **510** are greater distances than distances at which electrostatic forces can be generated to attract the first, second, and third portions of the convex substrate **504** to the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3**, respectively. In some embodiments, the distances **506**, **508**, **510** can be detected by a substrate bow measurement system disposed in a chamber that is within a system that includes the processing volume **108** such that the detected substrate bow can be provided to the controller **126** so that the displacement of the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** (such as the vertical displacement and/or lateral displacement) by the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** can be set to compensate for the detected distortion of the convex substrate **504**. In one or more embodiments, the distances **506**, **508**, **510** are described by premeasured bow information for the convex substrate **504**. In various embodiments, the premeasured bow information can be measured by the substrate bow measurement system and/or the sensors **512**, **514**. In certain embodiments, the premeasured bow information for the convex substrate **504** may also be utilized to dechuck the convex substrate **504** in the same or similar ways as the premeasured bow information for the concave substrate **404** can be utilized to dechuck the concave substrate **404**.

[0059] FIG. 5B illustrates a representation **501** of decreasing the distances between the surface of the ESC and the convex substrate **504**. In one or more embodiments, the controller **126** causes the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to actuate the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** towards the convex substrate **504**. In some embodiments, after actuating the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** towards the convex substrate **504**, the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** generate electrostatic forces which attract the first, second, and third portions of the convex substrate **504** to the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2**, **114-3**, respectively.

[0060] FIG. 5C illustrates a representation **502** of chucking the convex substrate **504**. In various embodiments, the controller **126** causes the DC bias to be applied to the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** and electrostatic forces are generated which attract the first portion (e.g., the first edge portion) of the convex substrate **504** to the surface **114-1**, the second portion (e.g., the central portion) of the convex substrate **504** to the surface **114-2**, and the third portion (e.g., the second edge portion) of the convex substrate **504** to the surface **114-3**. After chucking the convex substrate **504**, the convex substrate **504** may be flattened using the vacuum pressure from the vacuum source **132** via the vacuum chucking ports **125** and/or by actuating the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to flatten the convex substrate **504**. In some embodiments, the convex substrate **504** can be processed with or without flattening the convex substrate **504**. In one or more examples, after processing the convex substrate **504**, the convex substrate **504** can be dechucked by ceasing application of the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes **116-1**, **116-2**, **116-3** and/or by actuating the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** to dechuck the convex substrate **504**.

[0061] Notably, the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** and the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** facilitate processing of the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** without needing to flatten the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** before chucking. This increases efficiency of processing the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** and also avoids

potential damage to the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** caused by the flattening process. Additionally, as noted above, the segments **112-1**, **112-2**, **112-3** and the actuators **118-1**, **118-2**, **118-3** can also be used for dechucking which can reduce risks of damaging the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** during the dechucking process.

[0062] FIGS. **6A** and **6B** illustrate examples of a flexible membrane disposed below segments of a substrate support. FIG. **6A** illustrates a top view **600** of the substrate support. As shown, the substrate support includes a center segment **602**, middle segments **604**, first edge segments **606**, and second edge segments **608**. In some embodiments, the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, the first edge segments **606**, and the second edge segments **608** are disposed within a supporting structure **610**. The supporting structure includes a diameter **612** which may have a length between 200 and 400 millimeters such as 300 millimeters. In one or more embodiments, the length of the diameter may be less than 200 millimeters or greater than 400 millimeters.

[0063] FIG. **6B** illustrates a cross-sectional view **601** of the substrate support about line AA which is shown in FIG. **6A**. The cross-sectional view **601** includes an extendable distance **614** which surfaces of the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and the first edge segments **606** can extend relative to the supporting structure **610**. In some embodiments, the extendable distance **614** may be a length in a range of 0.1 to 8.0 millimeters. In other embodiments, the extendable distance can be less than 0.1 millimeters or greater than 8.0 millimeters.

[0064] As shown in FIG. **6B**, the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and the first edge segments **606** are disposed on a membrane **616**. In some embodiments, the membrane **616** includes a fluoroelastomer material such as a perfluoroelastomer material. In one or more embodiments, the membrane **616** is generally flexible such that a portion of the membrane **616** may deform if a force is applied to the portion. In various embodiments, actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626** are partially disposed in the membrane **616**.

[0065] In certain embodiments, a portion of the actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626** are fixed to a portion of the membrane **616**, for example, by an adhesive, an epoxy, a metal-joining process (e.g., welding, brazing, etc.), or the like to allow a seal and/or a bond to be formed between these components. In some embodiments, a portion of the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and the first edge segments **606** are fixed to the membrane **616**. In the illustrated example, adhesive joints **628** fix an extension portion of the actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626** and the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and the first edge segments **606** to the membrane **616**. In some embodiments, the adhesive joints **628** are used to form a seal between a portion of each of the actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626**, the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, the first edge segments **606** and the membrane **616** to fluidly isolate the processing volume **108** from an internal region **607** of the substrate support disposed below the membrane **616** and within the inner surfaces of the supporting structure **610**.

[0066] In various embodiments, the controller **126** is capable of controlling the transistors included in the PCB **120** to open or close electrical connections between the power supply **128** and the actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626**. In one or more embodiments, supplying power to electrical components of the actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626** causes the actuator **622** to actuate the center segment **602**; the actuators **620**, **624** to actuate the middle segments **604**; and the actuators **618**, **626** to actuate the first edge segments **606**.

[0067] The center segment **602** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown in FIGS. **6A-6B**) which are electrically connected to one or more circuits formed in the circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120**.

Similarly, the middle segments **604** and the first edge segments **606** each include a pair of electrodes (not shown) which are each electrically connected to the circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120**. The controller **126** can apply the DC bias to the pairs electrodes included in the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and/or the first edge segments **606** in order to chuck the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504**.

[0068] FIG. **6C** illustrates an additional cross-sectional view **603** of the substrate support about line

AA which is shown in FIG. 6A. In some embodiments, the actuators **618**, **620**, **622**, **624**, **626** each include a flange **630** disposed below the membrane **616**. In one or more embodiments, the membrane **616** is fixed to the bottom portions of the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and the first edge segments **606**. In the example illustrated in FIG. 6C, adhesive joints **632** fix a top portion of the membrane **616** to the bottom portions of the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, and the first edge segments **606**, and the flanges **630** are configured to urge the membrane **616** and the center segment **602**, the middle segments **604**, or the first edge segments **606** to a desired position in the Z-direction (such as the vertical direction). In various embodiments, as the actuator **622** actuates the center segment **602** away from the PCB **120**, a portion of the membrane **616** fixed to the bottom portion of the center segment **602** also actuates away from the PCB **120**. In some embodiments, an actuation of the actuator **622** which actuates the center segment **602** away from the PCB **120** also actuates the flange **630** of the actuator **622** away from the PCB **120**.

[0069] In various embodiments, the membrane **616** may be a flexible disk shaped member that has a diameter **612** and is manufactured from a polymer, metal or other useful material. In one example, the membrane **616** is formed from a metal material, such as Hastelloy, Haynes **202**, various nickel alloys, stainless steel (SST), or the like. In certain embodiments, the membrane **616** may be manufactured from a material configured for use in aggressive etching configurations, such as fluorine containing gas types of applications (e.g., for use in contact with fluorine). In one or more embodiments, the membrane **616** may include a coating (e.g., of a nickel alloy) configured for use in applications which also use fluorine.

[0070] FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate examples of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) including two segments. FIG. 7A illustrates a top view **700** of a substrate support of the ESC. As shown, the substrate support includes a first segment **702**, a second segment **704**, a non-moving portion **706**, and a seal band **708**. In some embodiments, the non-moving portion **706** is disposed between the first segment **702** and the second segment **704**. In certain embodiments, the first segment **702** is configured to chuck the concave substrate **404** and the second segment is configured to chuck the convex substrate **504**.

[0071] FIG. 7B illustrates a cross-sectional view **701** of the substrate support about line BB which is shown in FIG. 7A. The substrate support includes an actuator **710** configured to actuate the first segment **702** and at least one actuator **712** configured to actuate the second segment **704**. In various embodiments, the at least one actuator **712** is representative of multiple actuators which collectively are capable of extending/retracting the second segment **704** relative to the non-moving portion **706**. In some embodiments, the first segment **702** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown), and the second segment **704** includes at least one pair of electrodes (not shown). In one or more embodiments, the second segment **704** includes multiple pairs of electrodes (not shown). In some embodiments, the non-moving portion **706** includes one or more heaters **714** which may facilitate temperature control of the substrate support for thermal stability and thermal stress management of a substrate disposed on a surface of the substrate support.

[0072] In certain embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors included in the circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120** in order to open/close electrical connections between the DC voltage source **124** and pairs of electrodes included in the first segment **702** and/or the second segment **704**. In some embodiments, the instructions executed by the one or more processors of the controller **126** cause the one or more processors to control the transistors included in the circuit layer **122** in order to open/close electrical connections between the power supply **128** and electrical components of the actuator **710** and/or the at least one actuator **712**. In an example of chucking the concave substrate **404**, the controller **126** may supply power from the power supply **128** to electrical components of the actuator **710** to decrease a distance between a surface of the first segment **702** and a medial portion (e.g., a center portion) of the concave substrate **404**. In an example of

chucking the convex substrate **504**, the controller **126** can supply power from the power supply **128** to electrical components of the at least one actuator **712** to decrease a distance between a surface of the second segment **704** and lateral portion (e.g., an edge portion) of the convex substrate **504**. [0073] FIGS. **8A** and **8B** illustrate examples of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) including five segments. FIG. **8A** illustrates a top view **800** of a substrate support of the ESC. The substrate support is illustrated to include a first segment **802**, a second segment **804**, a third segment **806**, a fourth segment **808**, a fifth segment **810**, a non-moving portion **812**, and a seal band **814**. In some embodiments, the first segment **802** is disposed between the second segment **804**, the third segment **806**, the fourth segment **808**, and the fifth segment **810**. In one or more embodiments, the first segment **802** is configured to chuck the concave substrate **404** by use of an actuator **818** and one or more of the second segment **804**, the third segment **806**, the fourth segment **808**, and the fifth segment **810** are configured to chuck the convex substrate **504** by use of one or more actuators, such as actuators **816** or **820**.

[0074] FIG. **8B** illustrates a cross-sectional view **801** of the substrate support about line CC which is shown in FIG. **8A**. The substrate support is illustrated to include an actuator **816** for the fifth segment **810**, an actuator **818** for the first segment **802**, and an actuator **820** for the third segment **806**. In some embodiments, the substrate support also includes an actuator for the second segment **804** (not shown) and an actuator for the fourth segment **808** (not shown). In various embodiments, the first segment **802** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**; the second segment **804** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**; the third segment **806** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**; the fourth segment **808** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**; and the fifth segment **810** includes a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**. In one or more embodiments, the non-moving portion **812** includes one or more heaters **822** which can facilitate temperature control of the substrate support for thermal stability and thermal stress management of a substrate disposed on a surface of the substrate support.

[0075] In some embodiments, the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors included in the circuit layer **122** of the PCB **120** in order to open/close electrical connections between the DC voltage source **124** and pairs of electrodes (not shown) included in the first segment **802**, the second segment **804**, the third segment **806**, the fourth segment **808**, and/or the fifth segment **810**. In an example of chucking the concave substrate **404** (FIG. **4A**), the one or more processors of the controller **126** may supply power from the power supply **128** to electrical components of the actuator **818** to decrease a distance between a surface of the first segment **802** and a medial portion (e.g., a center portion) of the concave substrate **404**. In an example of chucking the convex substrate **504** (FIG. **5A**), the one or more processors of the controller **126** can supply power from the power supply **128** to electrical components of one or more of the actuator **816**, the actuator **820**, the actuator for the second segment **804** (not shown), and the an actuator for the fourth segment **808** (not shown) in order to decrease a distance between a surface of at least one of the second segment **804**, the third segment **806**, the fourth segment **808**, and the fifth segment **810** and a lateral portion (e.g., an edge portion) of the convex substrate **504**.

[0076] FIGS. **9A** and **9B** illustrate examples of an electrostatic chuck (ESC) including eight segments. FIG. **9A** illustrates a top view **900** of a substrate support of the ESC. In the illustrated example, the substrate support includes segments **902**, **904**, **906**, **908**, **910**, **912**, **914**, **916**. The substrate support is also illustrated to include a non-moving portion **918**, lift pins **920**, **922**, **924** disposed within the non-moving portion **918**, and a seal band **926**. In one or more embodiments, the lift pins **920**, **922**, **924** are configured to manipulate a portion of the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504**. In some embodiments, the lift pins **920**, **922**, **924** are configured to apply a force to a portion of the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** to reduce

a distance between the portion of the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** and a surface of the non-moving portion **918**. In various embodiments, the force applied to the portion of the concave substrate **404** and/or the convex substrate **504** may be a vacuum pressure (e.g., inner bores (not shown) of the lift pins **920**, **922**, **924** can be coupled to the vacuum chucking ports **125**), a mechanical force (e.g., the lift pins **920**, **922**, **924** may include hooks or tabs), and/or another force. In some embodiments, the segments **902**, **906** are configured to chuck the concave substrate **404**. In certain embodiments, the segments **904**, **908**, **910**, **912**, **914**, **914** are configured to chuck the convex substrate **504**.

[0077] FIG. **9B** illustrates a cross-sectional view **901** of the substrate support about line DD which is illustrated in FIG. **9A**. As shown in FIG. **9B**, the substrate support includes an actuator **928** for the segment **916**, an actuator **930** for the segment **902**, and an actuator **932** for the segment **912**. In various embodiments, the substrate support also includes at least one actuator (not shown) for the segments **904**, **906**, **908**, **910**, **914**. In some embodiments, the segments **902**, **912**, **916** each include a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**. In one or more embodiments, the segments **904**, **906**, **908**, **910**, **914** also each include a pair of electrodes (not shown) electrically connected to the circuit layer **122**. In certain embodiments, the non-moving portion **918** includes one or more heaters **934** which can facilitate temperature control of the substrate support for thermal stability and thermal stress management of a substrate disposed on a surface of the substrate support.

[0078] In an example of chucking the concave substrate **404** (FIG. **4A**), the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** in order to supply power from the power supply **128** to electrical components of the actuator **930** and/or an actuator for the segment **906** (not shown). In one or more embodiments, supplying power from the power supply **128** to the electrical components of the actuator **930** causes the actuator **930** to actuate a surface of the segment **902** towards a medial portion (e.g., a center portion) of the concave substrate **404** and decreases a distance between the surface of the segment **902** and the medial portion of the concave substrate **404**. In an example of chucking the convex substrate **504** (FIG. **5A**), the one or more processors of the controller **126** execute instructions which cause the one or more processors to control the transistors in the circuit layer **122** in order to supply power from the power supply **128** to electrical components of the actuators **928**, **932** and/or actuators for the segments **904**, **908**, **910**, **914** (not shown). In various embodiments, supplying power from the power supply **128** to the electrical components of the actuators **928**, **932** causes the actuators **928**, **932** to actuate surfaces of the segments **916**, **912**, respectively, towards a lateral portion (e.g., an edge portion) of the convex substrate **504**. In some embodiments, actuating the surfaces of the segments **912**, **916** towards the lateral portion of the convex substrate **504** decreases a distance between the surfaces of the segments **912**, **916** and the lateral portion of the convex substrate **504**.

[0079] FIG. **10** is a flow diagram illustrating a method **1000** for substrate processing by chucking a substrate to a substrate support. At **1002**, a first distance is determined between a surface of a first segment of a substrate support and a first portion of a substrate. In one or more embodiments, the distance between the first portion of the substrate (e.g., such as the distance **406** shown in FIG. **4A**, or the distance **506** shown in FIG. **5A**) and the surface **114-1** of the segment **112-1** is detected by the sensors **412**, **414**. In one or more embodiments, the first distance at **1002** may be a maximum distance or an average distance between the first portion of the substrate and the surface **114-1** of the segment **112-1**.

[0080] At **1004**, a second distance is determined between a surface of a second segment of the substrate support and a second portion of the substrate. In some embodiments, the distance between the second portion of the substrate (e.g., such as the distance **408** shown in FIG. **4A**, or the distance **508** shown in FIG. **5A**) and the surface **114-2** of the segment **112-2** is detected by the sensors **412**, **414**. In one or more embodiments, the second distance may be a maximum distance or an average

distance between the second portion of the substrate and the surface **114-2** of the segment **112-2**.
[0081] At **1006**, a first pair of electrodes included in the first segment is actuated to reduce the first distance. In various embodiments, the controller **126** causes the actuator **118-1** to actuate the pair of electrodes **116-1** included in the segment **112-1** towards the first portion of the substrate to reduce a distance therebetween.

[0082] At **1008**, a second pair of electrodes included in the second segment is actuated to reduce the second distance. In various embodiments, the controller **126** causes the actuator **118-2** to actuate the pair of electrodes **116-2** included in the segment **112-2** towards the second portion of the substrate to reduce a distance therebetween.

[0083] At **1010**, a DC bias is applied to the first pair of electrodes and the second pair of electrodes. In one or more embodiments, the controller **126** causes the DC bias to be applied to the pair of electrodes **116-1** and the pair of electrodes **116-2** in order to generate the electrostatic forces to attract the first portion of the substrate to the surface **114-1** and to attract the second portion of the substrate to the surface **114-2**.

[0084] In some embodiments of the method **1000**, after applying the DC bias to the pairs of electrodes (i.e., performing operation **1010**), the controller **126** is configured adjust the position of the segments of the substrate support by use of the actuators to cause the substrate to achieve a planar (e.g., flat) or near planar state during processing in the processing system. In one example, the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2** and **114-3** of the segments are re-positioned so that the surfaces **114-1**, **114-2** and **114-3** are positioned within a common plane. As discussed above, in some embodiments, during the dechucking process, which may be performed after chucking the substrate and positioning the substrate in a planar state, the controller **126** is configured re-adjust the position of the segments of the substrate support by use of the actuators to cause the substrate to re-deform back to its original deformed shape to avoid rapid spring-back of the substrate during the dechucking process. The rapid spring-back during the dechucking process can cause the substrate to be undesirably repositioned over the surface of the substrate support and/or cause damage to the substrate.

Additional Considerations

[0085] In the above description, details are set forth by way of example to facilitate an understanding of the disclosed subject matter. It should be apparent to a person of ordinary skill in the field, however, that the disclosed implementations are exemplary and not exhaustive of all possible implementations. Thus, it should be understood that reference to the described examples is not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure. Any alterations and further modifications to the described devices, instruments, methods, and any further application of the principles of the present disclosure are fully contemplated as would normally occur to one skilled in the art to which the disclosure relates. In particular, it is fully contemplated that the features, components, and/or steps described with respect to one implementation may be combined with the features, components, and/or steps described with respect to other implementations of the present disclosure. As used herein, the term “about” may refer to a $\pm 10\%$ variation from the nominal value. It is to be understood that such a variation can be included in any value provided herein.

[0086] As used herein, “a processor,” “at least one processor” or “one or more processors” generally refers to a single processor configured to perform one or multiple operations or multiple processors configured to collectively perform one or more operations. In the case of multiple processors, performance of the one or more operations could be divided amongst different processors, though one processor may perform multiple operations, and multiple processors could collectively perform a single operation. Similarly, “a memory,” “at least one memory” or “one or more memories” generally refers to a single memory configured to store data and/or instructions, multiple memories configured to collectively store data and/or instructions.

[0087] As used herein, a phrase referring to “at least one of” a list of items refers to any combination of those items, including single members. As an example, “at least one of: a, b, or c”

is intended to cover: a, b, c, a-b, a-c, b-c, and a-b-c, as well as any combination with multiples of the same element (e.g., a-a, a-a-a, a-a-b, a-a-c, a-b-b, a-c-c, b-b, b-b-b, b-b-c, c-c, and c-c-c or any other ordering of a, b, and c).

[0088] The methods disclosed herein comprise one or more steps or actions for achieving the described method. The method steps and/or actions may be interchanged with one another without departing from the scope of the claims. In other words, unless a specific order of steps or actions is specified, the order and/or use of specific steps and/or actions may be modified without departing from the scope of the claims. The recitation of identifiers such as (a), (b), (c) or (1), (2), (3) before steps in a method claim are not intended to and do not specify a particular order to the steps, but rather are used to simplify subsequent reference to such steps.

[0089] While the foregoing is directed to embodiments of the present disclosure, other and further embodiments of the disclosure may be devised without departing from the basic scope thereof, and the scope thereof is determined by the claims that follow.

Claims

1. An electrostatic chuck (ESC) comprising: a substrate support including a first segment and a second segment that is laterally adjacent to the first segment, the first segment including a first pair of electrodes, the second segment including a second pair of electrodes, and the first segment being configured to be displaced vertically relative to the second segment to accommodate a non-planar surface of a substrate.
2. The ESC of claim 1, further comprising: a third segment of the substrate support including a third pair of electrodes, and the third segment being configured to be displaced vertically relative to the first segment and the second segment.
3. The ESC of claim 1, wherein the first segment is configured such that vertical displacement of the first segment relative to the second segment is configured to translate the first segment both vertically and laterally relative to the second segment.
4. The ESC of claim 3, wherein the first segment is configured such that vertical displacement of the first segment relative to the second segment is configured to translate the first segment vertically upward and laterally away from the second segment to accommodate a concave surface of the substrate.
5. The ESC of claim 3, wherein the first segment is configured such that vertical displacement of the first segment relative to the second segment is configured to translate the first segment vertically upward and laterally toward from the second segment to accommodate a convex surface of the substrate.
6. The ESC of claim 1, wherein the first pair of electrodes is configured to generate a first electrostatic force between the first segment and a first portion of the substrate to chuck the first portion of the substrate to the first segment, and the second pair of electrodes is configured to generate a second electrostatic force between the second segment and a second portion of the substrate to chuck the second portion to the substrate to the second segment.
7. The ESC of claim 6, further comprising a membrane that is coupled to a side of the first segment and the second segment that is opposite from the substrate.
8. The ESC of claim 1, further comprising a diaphragm positioned over the first segment and the second segment such that the diaphragm covers an opening between the first segment and the second segment.
9. The ESC of claim 1, further comprising a first actuator that is configured to vertically displace the first segment and a second actuator that is configured to vertically displace the second segment.
10. A method for chucking a substrate to a substrate support comprising: (a) determining a first distance between a surface of a first segment of the substrate support and a first portion of the substrate; (b) determining a second distance between a surface of a second segment of the substrate

support and a second portion of the substrate; (c) actuating the first segment toward the first portion of the substrate to reduce the first distance; (d) actuating the second segment toward the second portion of the substrate to reduce the second distance; and (e) applying a DC bias to a first pair of electrodes included in the first segment and to a second pair of electrodes included in the second segment to chuck the first and second portions of the substrate to the first and second segments, respectively.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein (c) comprises displacing the first segment vertically within a processing volume, and wherein (d) comprises displacing the second segment in both vertically and laterally within the processing volume.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the first segment is laterally adjacent to the second segment.

13. The method of claim 12, wherein (d) comprises displacing the second segment laterally toward the first segment.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein (d) comprises displacing the second segment laterally away from the first segment.

15. The method of claim 12, further comprising deforming a membrane that is positioned below the first segment and the second segment during (c) and (d).

16. The method of claim 12, further comprising deforming a diaphragm that covers a top surface of the first segment, a second surface of the second segment, and an opening between the first segment and the second segment.

17. An electrostatic chuck (ESC) comprising: a substrate support including a first segment and a second segment that is laterally adjacent to the first segment; a first actuator coupled to the first segment that is configured to vertically displace the first segment to reduce a distance between the first segment and a surface of a substrate; a second actuator coupled to the second segment that is configured to vertically displace the second segment to reduce a distance between the second segment and the surface of the substrate; a first pair of electrodes coupled to the first segment that, when energized, are configured to generate a first electrostatic force to urge the substrate toward the first segment; and a second pair of electrodes coupled to the second segment that, when energized, are configured to generate a second electrostatic force to urge the substrate toward the second segment.

18. The ESC of claim 17, wherein the first actuator is configured to displace the first segment both vertically and laterally relative to the second segment.

19. The ESC of claim 18, further comprising a diaphragm positioned over the first segment, the second segment, and an opening between the first segment and the second segment, wherein the first pair of electrodes and the second pair of electrodes are positioned in the diaphragm.

20. The ESC of claim 18, further comprising a membrane positioned below the first segment and the second segment, wherein vertical displacement of the first segment or the second segment is configured to deform the membrane.
